

mail of the week

with players jumping from one team to another for a few more dollars.

K.V. SATYAMURTY, *on e-mail*

The pace at which cricket is shrinking and money is swelling, the day is not far when it will be played on a round table with only money.

RAJNEESH BATRA, *Delhi*

Auction of human beings is the height of disgrace. Can such a game be still considered a Gentleman's game?

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

A Ride Made Smooth

As someone who travels by bus, I would like to thank Upendra Tripathy for his dedication towards ensuring a smooth ride for bus passengers ("Steering a Roadworthy Story", March 3). One would like to see an in-depth story on this.

C.E. GOPALAKRISHNAN, *on e-mail*

Divide and Lose

What is the need for bifurcating Andhra Pradesh ("Losing to Gain", March 3)? Creating a new state means constructing a separate high court, a Raj Bhavan, which is quite costly.

K. PRADEEP, *Chennai*

Passport to Future

There is no problem in introducing some biometric system in the passport based on the software being developed by a private vendor ("Stamp of a Scam", March 3). These new features will only enhance the security of the document.

K.R. VENKATA NARASIMHAN, *Bangalore*

Dubious Goal

Rajasekhara Reddy is aiming at what most people in power do—leaving the successor with abundant liabilities and zero assets ("Discount on Religion", February 25).

K.R.P. GUPTA, *on e-mail*

Trample not Money

The illustration on the cover of the magazine of an executive going up the stairs of money trampling Goddess Lakshmi—

whom we Hindus revere—was in bad taste and unnecessary ("Gimme More", February 24)

AJAY KUMAR CHAKRABARTI, *on e-mail*

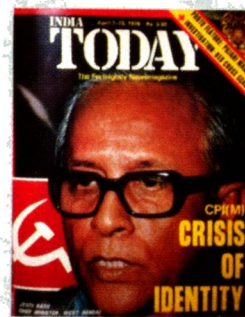
Correction

Rajendra Pachauri heads IPCC, which got the Nobel prize in 2007. He is not the seventh Nobel laureate from the country as has been mentioned in "A Guide to the High and Mighty" (March 10). The error is regretted.

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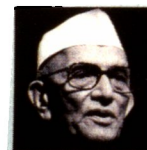
Years Ago in India Today

APRIL 1-15, 1978



Torn with Strife

There is an old *New Yorker* cartoon that shows a radio journalist, microphone in hand, approaching a rundown man at a bus-stop for a spot comment. The bystander, in horror, says, "Why me? I'm only the people." There is none of that misplaced modesty evident in the current wrangling amongst sections of the Janata



Party. But there is a misplaced illusion. Janata ministers no longer see themselves as representatives of the people. So when a Janata minister these days talks of "the people", he is not mouthing a well-worn cliché: he is talking of the Jana Sangh, the BLD or the Socialists, depending on the group he belongs to. And if he speaks of "democratic functioning" in the party, he is making rude noises about the group he does not belong to. When he says "organisational elections", it is usually something he spends sleepless nights over.

—Sunil Sethi

FLIMSY HISTORY



It is bad when filmmakers try to twist the truth in the name of entertainment and worse when they do not accept their mistakes and start defending themselves ("Romeo and Juliet in Rajasthan", March 3).

INDU SHANKAR, *on e-mail*

Spending a fortune on a worthless and unimaginative story was a sheer waste of time, effort and money. In the process, the makers of *Jodhaa Akbar* have offended the sentiments of the Rajputs too. Was all this necessary?

K.M.G. VIVEKANANDAM, *Madurai*

The article should have been more charitable to Ashutosh Gowariker considering the fact that is an issue on which even historians differ. Is it not sufficient that in the final analysis, Akbar has been projected as what history has known and believed him to be?

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *on e-mail*

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